

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 36

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Robert Andrew Huddleston of Wilson County.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Robert Andrew Huddleston, a highly respected member of his community who has dedicated himself to improving the quality of life for his fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, a native of Wilson County, Andy Huddleston graduated from Lebanon High School in 1971 and attended Nashville Technical Institute, where he briefly studied electrical engineering before transferring to Union University in Jackson; and

WHEREAS, it was at Union University where his career in ministry began, and he went on to graduate with a Bachelor of Arts degree in Christian Ministries from the University of the Nations in Kailua Kona, Hawaii; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Huddleston began his career as a missionary in 1977 and continued this work for forty years with a non-denominational para-church organization called Youth With A Mission (YWAM); and

WHEREAS, during his time with YWAM, he developed a Volunteer Support Development Seminar to assist faith-based organizations with financial support services and training; in 2017, he departed the organization as a staff development coordinator at YWAM's headquarters in Kailua Kona, Hawaii; and

WHEREAS, an ordained minister and Bible teacher, Mr. Huddleston has a decades-long career in pairing biblical principles with his lectures on the financial workings of international ministries; and

WHEREAS, Andy Huddleston taught biblical principles of self-finance nationally and internationally from 1991 to 2022, and in 2000, he established a nonprofit, Mission Enablers International, to service the finances of missionaries and ministries; and

WHEREAS, currently, he is founder and president of MEI, headquartered in Bentonville, Arkansas; under his leadership, MEI regularly publishes books by Christian authors and continues to serve YWAM ministry locations in Adams, Tennessee, and Heredia, Costa Rica, as well as numerous organizations, churches, and freelance missionaries. He also presides over the Tennessee nonprofit Kenya Islands Mission, which supports eco-missions in Kenya; and

WHEREAS, wholly devoted to his family, Mr. Huddleston is grateful for the love and support of his wife of fifty years, the former Susan Grace McMahon of Appleton, Wisconsin; together, the couple has been blessed with seven children and nineteen grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, in his memoir, *White Knuckle Faith*, he documents his and his wife's journey in Central America as a young and growing family relying on God's providence; and

WHEREAS, Andy Huddleston epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly acknowledge and applaud Mr. Huddleston for his dedication to the State of Tennessee and its citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Robert Andrew Huddleston

for his lifetime of service in ministry and as a missionary, teacher, and leader, extending to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.